

4.10 Lesson: The Commands You Will Use Every Day



Your Command List

Here is a compact reference of the Git commands that cover 95% of day-to-day work. If you would like to print this page for future reference, you can click the print icon in the top right corner of this page.

Table 1: *Command Reference Table*

Command	What it does	When you would use it
<code>git status</code>	Shows what has changed since the last commit	Before any add or commit
<code>git add <file></code>	Stages a specific file for the next commit	After editing files you want to commit
<code>git add .</code>	Stages all changed files in the current folder	When you want to commit everything
<code>git commit -m "msg"</code>	Saves a snapshot with a message	After staging the right files
<code>git push</code>	Sends local commits to GitHub	After committing, to back up and share
<code>git pull</code>	Gets new commits from GitHub to your machine	Before starting new work; after others push
<code>git log</code>	Shows the commit history	To review what changed and when

<code>git log --oneline</code>	Compact one line view of history	Quick overview of recent commits
<code>git diff</code>	Shows unstaged changes line by line	Before staging, to review your edits
<code>git branch</code>	Lists all branches	To see what branches exist
<code>git checkout -b name</code>	Creates and switches to a new branch	When starting a new feature or fix
<code>git checkout main</code>	Switches back to the main branch	After finishing work on a branch
<code>git merge <branch></code>	Merges a branch into the current branch	After completing work on a feature branch
<code>git clone <url></code>	Copies a GitHub repository to your machine	Once, when first setting up a project



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